

France's World Cup Run - Past Simple vs Present Perfect

Name: _____

Date: _____

2. The timeline (5 min)

France **beat** Sweden 3-0 in the round of 32.

In the round of 16, Kylian Mbappé **scored** the only goal of the match against Paraguay – a converted penalty in a tense, goalless game.

That goal **was** his 19th World Cup goal, which means Mbappé **has** now **scored** more World Cup goals than almost any player in France's history.

On July 9, France **[UPDATE: beat / lost to]** Morocco in the quarterfinal, in Foxborough.

Going into this stage of the tournament, France **had** already **reached** the quarterfinals in every World Cup since 2014 – this **is** their fourth in a row.

[UPDATE: France have now reached the semi-final. / France's run ended in the quarterfinal.]

3. Notice the pattern (5 min)

Ask the group to sort the underlined/circled verbs into two columns on the board: **Past Simple** and **Present Perfect**. Then elicit the rule from *them* rather than giving it upfront:

Past Simple	Present Perfect
A specific, finished event – often with a date, an opponent, a score	A result or record that's still true / relevant <i>now</i> , no specific date given
<i>France beat Sweden 3-0.</i>	<i>France have reached four quarterfinals in a row.</i>
<i>Mbappé scored the winning penalty.</i>	<i>Mbappé has scored 19 World Cup goals.</i>

Useful prompt if they're stuck: "Which sentences could you attach a date to? Which ones are more like a running total or an ongoing achievement?"

4. Transformation practice (5-7 min)

Students rewrite each sentence in the other tense, adjusting the rest of the sentence if needed. Do the first one together as an example.

1. France **won** three of their group-stage matches. France **have won** three World Cups.
(different meaning – discuss briefly: one is this tournament, one is history)
 2. Mbappé **has scored** in every knockout round so far. Mbappé **scored** in the round of 16 match against Paraguay.
 3. France **beat** Sweden 3-0 in the round of 32. _____
 4. This **is** France's fourth consecutive quarterfinal. Before this tournament, France _
three consecutive quarterfinals.
 5. **[UPDATE result sentence]** _____
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5. Quick speaking task (3-5 min)

Pairs: one student narrates **one specific match** using past simple (score, key moment, one detail), the other summarises **France's campaign as a whole** using present perfect (how far they've come, records, form). Swap.

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Before class

Fill in the two blanks marked **[UPDATE]** below with the real result once you know it (France played Morocco in the quarterfinal on July 9 – before the stay starts, so you'll have this by Day 1).

1. Warm-up (2-3 min)

Ask the group: *What do you already know about France's World Cup so far?* Take 2–3 answers orally before looking at the timeline – this primes the tenses you're about to contrast.

About this activity

B1-B2 – standalone activity, ~20–25 min – works with or without a projector

2. The timeline (5 min)

Read through together. Ask students to underline every ****past simple**** verb in blue and every ****present perfect**** verb in red (or circle/square if no colours available).

5. Quick speaking task (3-5 min)

Note: written from publicly available match results (round of 32 vs Sweden, round of 16 vs Paraguay) as of July 7, 2026 – double-check the quarterfinal result before using, since it's a fast-moving news cycle.